BUILD YOUR AI CEO — THE COMPLETE SETUP GUIDE

OpenClaw Terminal Setup Cheat Sheet

Module 4, Video 1 — Classic QuickStart Installation

Mac and Windows (Ubuntu/WSL2)

MODULE 4 · TERMINAL SETUP

Every question the wizard asks — and exactly what to answer.

CYRUSHQ.AI

BEFORE YOU START

Make sure you've completed the earlier course lessons and have:

- A Mac or Windows computer with the prerequisites from Module 4 installed
- Terminal (Mac) or Ubuntu/WSL2 Terminal (Windows)
- OpenClaw installed
- Your AI provider account and API key ready
- Active billing or available API credits with your provider

Security Reminders

- Never share your API keys, Discord tokens, or passwords with anyone
- If Terminal displays a secret, do not include it in screenshots
- Read all security notices carefully before confirming

LAUNCH THE WIZARD

```
openclaw onboard --classic --flow quickstart --install-daemon --skip-channels --skip-skills --skip-hooks --skip-search
```

Already entered this command? If you completed the previous lesson's PDF (Step 9 — Run the Setup Wizard), you've already run this command and your wizard is active. You're in the right place — just follow the step-by-step guide below to answer each question as it appears.

Haven't entered it yet? Copy and paste the command above into Terminal now and press Enter before continuing.

This command pre-selects the Classic QuickStart path and automatically skips Discord, skills, hooks, and web search — so the wizard takes you straight through the essential steps only. We'll set those up together in later lessons.

This cheat sheet gives you the answer to every question, in the exact order they appear.

Note: The wizard may skip some steps automatically based on your selections. If a screen doesn't match what's described here, find the matching topic rather than relying on step numbers.

STEP 1 — EXISTING CONFIG CHECK

WHAT YOU'LL SEE

If this is your first time, the wizard moves straight to Step 2. You won't see this prompt.

If you've run OpenClaw before, it may ask:

"Config already exists. Keep, Modify, or Reset?"

✅ **ANSWER**

- **Keep** — if your config is working
- **Reset** — only if starting completely fresh

💡 **WHY**

Choosing Reset wipes your existing setup. Only do this if you want to start over from scratch. Never select Reset simply because your screen looks different.

STEP 2 — SECURITY ACKNOWLEDGMENT

WHAT YOU'LL SEE

A security notice explaining that OpenClaw can access files, execute tools, or interact with connected services depending on its permissions. You may be asked to acknowledge the risks before continuing.

✅ **ANSWER**

Read the notice carefully. If you understand and accept, confirm and continue.

If you're unsure — stop and review before proceeding.

💡 **WHY**

You're installing an AI agent platform, not just a chat application. Later in the course, you may connect tools that can take real actions on your behalf. Those permissions should be introduced deliberately.

STEP 3 — SETUP MODE

WHAT YOU'LL SEE

"QuickStart (recommended defaults) or Advanced (full control)?"

Because the launch command already selects Classic QuickStart, OpenClaw may skip this question entirely. If it appears:

✅ **ANSWER**

QuickStart

💡 **WHY**

QuickStart sets smart defaults for everything — port, bind address, auth mode, and security settings. You don't need to configure those manually. Advanced mode exposes every setting, which is overwhelming when you're just getting started.

STEP 4 — WORKSPACE LOCATION

WHAT YOU'LL SEE

"Where should your workspace live? [~/.openclaw/workspace]"

✅ **ANSWER**

Press **Enter** to accept the default location.

Your workspace will be at: `~/.openclaw/workspace`

If you prefer a custom location, type your path (example: `/Users/your-username/workspace`).

To find your username: type `whoami` in Terminal and press Enter.

💡 **WHY**

The workspace is the folder where all your AI's identity files, memory, and operating documents live. The default location works perfectly. Use a custom path only if you have a specific reason.

Note: If you have an existing OpenClaw installation, your workspace may already be configured elsewhere. Do not move or replace it without checking first.

STEP 5 — CHOOSE YOUR AI MODEL PROVIDER

WHAT YOU'LL SEE

A list of supported AI providers. Depending on your version, it may include:

- Anthropic — Claude
- OpenAI
- OpenRouter
- xAI — Grok
- Google — Gemini
- Custom Provider
- Skip

✅ **ANSWER**

Select **Anthropic (Claude) — API key**

💡 **WHY**

This course uses Claude Sonnet, which runs on Anthropic. You need an Anthropic API key. If you haven't gotten your API key yet, pause here and complete Module 2 first.

Important: A Claude consumer subscription (like Claude.ai) is not the same as API access. Make sure you set up API access from the earlier lesson.

You can also use any model you want, just be sure to set it up and get the API key.

STEP 6 — CHOOSE YOUR AUTHENTICATION METHOD

WHAT YOU'LL SEE

OpenClaw may ask how you want to authenticate with your selected provider. Options may include:

- API key
- OAuth or browser sign-in
- Existing saved credentials
- Custom endpoint

✅ **ANSWER**

Select **Anthropic API key**

💡 **WHY**

This matches the setup from Module 2. If your provider is different, select the method that matches what you prepared.

STEP 7 — ENTER YOUR API KEY

WHAT YOU'LL SEE

"Enter your Anthropic API key:"

✅ **ANSWER**

Paste your Anthropic API key here.

Your key looks like: `sk-ant-api03-xxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxx`

To get it: Go to console.anthropic.com → API Keys → Create Key

⚠ The cursor won't move while you paste. That's normal — Terminal hides API keys for security. Just paste and press Enter.

Security reminder: Never paste your API key into Discord, a public forum, or a troubleshooting conversation.

STEP 8 — CHOOSE YOUR DEFAULT AI MODEL

WHAT YOU'LL SEE

A list of available models. Something like:

1. claude-sonnet-4-6 (recommended)
2. claude-opus-4-6
3. claude-haiku-4-6
4. Enter manually

✅ **ANSWER**

Select **claude-sonnet-4-6** (or whichever option says "recommended" or "Sonnet")

💡 **WHY**

Claude Sonnet is the right balance of capability and cost. Opus is more powerful but significantly more expensive. Haiku is faster but less capable for complex AI CEO tasks.

If your model isn't listed: Don't guess or enter an unfamiliar model ID. Check that you selected the correct provider, your account has access, and your credentials are valid.

STEP 9 — OPTIONAL MODEL CONNECTION TEST

WHAT YOU'LL SEE

An option to perform a live completion or connection test.

✅ **ANSWER**

Run the test if it's offered.

💡 **WHY**

A live test confirms OpenClaw can actually communicate with your AI provider. A saved key alone doesn't prove requests will work.

If the test fails, common causes include:

- Invalid or expired credentials
- Insufficient API credits (make sure you purchased credits in the provider platform)
- Billing restrictions
- An unavailable model
- Temporary provider or network issue

Don't repeatedly run paid tests if there's a billing problem. Resolve the issue first.

STEP 10 — OPTIONAL MEMORY EMBEDDINGS

WHAT YOU'LL SEE

An option to configure memory embeddings for enhanced search and retrieval.

✅ **ANSWER**

Skip for now.

💡 **WHY**

We're focused on getting your AI CEO installed and connected to Discord. Memory embeddings can be configured later. Skipping this does not affect your ability to place your personalized workspace files.

Note: Memory embeddings are not the same as your identity and business files. Your workspace files are still essential.

STEP 11 — GATEWAY CONFIGURATION

WHAT YOU'LL SEE

Settings for the OpenClaw gateway service. Classic QuickStart normally applies these automatically without asking you individually.

✅ **ANSWER**

Keep the QuickStart defaults. (Select and press enter)

Setting	Recommended Value
Gateway mode	Local
Gateway port	18789
Bind address	Loopback / local computer
Gateway authentication	Token
Gateway token	Automatically generated
Tailscale exposure	Off

💡 **WHY**

These settings keep the gateway local to your computer and require authentication. You do not need to expose your gateway to the internet to use Discord.

⚠ Do not change the bind address to expose the gateway to your network or the internet. Do not disable gateway authentication.

STEP 12 — OPTIONAL GATEWAY SECRET STORAGE

WHAT YOU'LL SEE

Options for storing the gateway authentication secret. May include local storage or environment variable references.

✅ **ANSWER**

Use the supported **default storage option**.

💡 **WHY**

Our goal is a straightforward local installation. The gateway token is separate from your Anthropic API key and your Discord bot token. Keep all of them private.

STEP 13 — DISCORD AND OTHER MESSAGING CHANNELS

WHAT YOU'LL SEE

An option to configure messaging channels such as Discord, Telegram, Slack, or WhatsApp.

✅ **ANSWER**

Skip for now.

💡 **WHY**

We have a separate lesson specifically for Discord setup in Module 4, Video 3. Do not enter your Discord bot token here. In that lesson, you'll:

- Invite your Discord bot
- Save its token securely
- Configure your server
- Add your operator and approved channels

STEP 14 — WEB SEARCH

WHAT YOU'LL SEE

An option to configure web search. The launch command includes `--skip-search`, so this will likely be bypassed automatically.

✅ **ANSWER**

Skip for now.

💡 **WHY**

We'll enable web search immediately after the onboarding wizard finishes. It's one of the most valuable capabilities you can give your AI CEO — we want to do it right.

STEP 15 — OPTIONAL SKILLS AND HOOKS

WHAT YOU'LL SEE

An option to configure additional skills or automation hooks.

✅ **ANSWER**

Skip for now (or select No/Skip if prompted).

💡 **WHY**

We're focused on getting your AI CEO installed and connected to Discord first. You can add skills and automations later as your system grows. If this question doesn't appear, that's perfectly normal.

STEP 16 — INSTALL THE BACKGROUND GATEWAY SERVICE

WHAT YOU'LL SEE

A question about installing the gateway service or daemon.

✅ **ANSWER**

Yes — install the background service.

Mac users: OpenClaw installs a macOS LaunchAgent, allowing the gateway to run under your user account.

Windows users (WSL2): OpenClaw installs a Linux systemd user service inside WSL2.

💡 **WHY**

A managed service makes it easier to start, stop, and restart OpenClaw and supports more persistent operation.

Important: A background service does not guarantee 24/7 availability. Your computer still needs to be running and connected. If your computer sleeps or shuts down, your AI CEO may become unavailable.

STEP 17 — HEALTH CHECK

WHAT YOU'LL SEE

A message indicating whether the gateway started and is reachable.

✅ **ANSWER**

No input needed — wait for it to complete.

💡 **WHY**

This confirms the gateway service is installed and reachable.

Important: A successful health check does not mean your Discord connection is working. We're intentionally configuring Discord in a separate lesson. If you see an error, review it and consult the troubleshooting section before making changes.

STEP 18 — OPTIONAL DASHBOARD

WHAT YOU'LL SEE

An offer to open the OpenClaw web dashboard (also called the Control UI).

✅ **ANSWER**

Skip or select No.

💡 **WHY**

We'll use Discord as your primary communication channel. You don't need the dashboard to complete this course, but you can access it later to explore additional OpenClaw features. If this question doesn't appear, simply continue.

STEP 19 — SETUP COMPLETE!

Congratulations — you've completed the foundational OpenClaw installation!

At this point you should have:

- ✅ OpenClaw installed
- ✅ Your AI provider configured
- ✅ Your default AI model selected
- ✅ Your workspace location established
- ✅ Your local gateway configured
- ✅ A managed gateway service installed

Verify the gateway:

```
openclaw gateway status
```

Find your workspace:

```
openclaw config get agents.defaults.workspace
```

You'll use this folder in the next lesson when installing your personalized AI CEO files.

HOW TO OPEN YOUR WORKSPACE FOLDER

Mac users — run this in Terminal:

```
open "$(openclaw config get agents.defaults.workspace)"
```

This opens your workspace directly in Finder.

Windows users (WSL2) — run this in your WSL terminal:

```
explorer.exe "$(wslpath -w "$(openclaw config get agents.defaults.workspace)")"
```

⭐ HOW TO ENABLE WEB SEARCH AFTER ONBOARDING

We recommend **Tavily** — the same web search provider used by Cyrus, the AI CEO in this course. Tavily is purpose-built for AI applications.

After the wizard is complete, follow these steps:

1. Create your Tavily account — Visit https://tavily.com and create an account.
2. Get your API key — Open your Tavily dashboard and copy your API key. Keep it somewhere secure.
3. Run the web search configuration:

```
openclaw configure --section web
```

1. Select Tavily as your search provider when OpenClaw shows available providers.
2. Enter your Tavily API key when requested.

Note: Tavily requires its own API key — separate from your Anthropic API key. Complete the full onboarding wizard first. Then set up Tavily before moving to Module 4, Video 2.

QUICK TROUBLESHOOTING

Problem 1 — "openclaw: command not found"

Close and reopen Terminal. Then try:

```
openclaw --version
```

If still not recognized, return to the Module 4 installation instructions. Check your Node.js and npm configuration before reinstalling.

Problem 2 — My API key was rejected

Check that:

- The key belongs to the provider you selected
- The key hasn't expired or been revoked
- Your account has the required access
- Billing or credits are available
- You haven't accidentally added extra characters

Never share your key while troubleshooting.

Problem 3 — I don't see the same wizard questions

That's okay. Some questions are skipped automatically by QuickStart, and others appear only for specific providers or existing installations.

1. Read the exact question
2. Find the matching topic in this guide
3. Follow the recommended choice
4. If unsure, stop and ask for help before selecting anything that changes files or credentials

Problem 4 — The gateway won't start

Check status and run diagnostics:

```
openclaw gateway status
openclaw doctor
```

Review results carefully. Do not run automatic fixes or delete config files without understanding what they do.

Problem 5 — Port 18789 is already in use

Do not immediately change the port or start multiple gateways. First check:

```
openclaw gateway status
```

If the gateway is already running, you may not need to start another instance.

Problem 6 — Should I reset OpenClaw?

Not as a first troubleshooting step. Reset operations can remove configuration, credentials, sessions, and workspace data. Start with diagnostics and identify the actual problem before considering a reset.

> 💡 **TIME-SAVING HACK — USE CHATGPT OR GROK FOR TROUBLESHOOTING**

Terminal output can look intimidating. You don't have to figure it out alone.

How to do it:

1. Copy the Terminal output
2. Remove any API keys, tokens, passwords, or private URLs
3. Open ChatGPT or Grok
4. Paste with the prompt below

COPY & PASTE THIS TROUBLESHOOTING PROMPT:

```
I'm a complete beginner installing OpenClaw for the Build Your AI CEO course.
I'm using the Classic QuickStart onboarding wizard.

My computer is: [MAC / WINDOWS WITH UBUNTU WSL2]

The question or problem I'm seeing is: [DESCRIBE THE ISSUE]

Here is my Terminal output: [PASTE REDACTED OUTPUT HERE]

Please act as a patient OpenClaw installation expert.
Explain in simple language what I'm seeing and whether it is a normal wizard prompt, warning,
or error.
Help me identify the correct next action.
Give me only ONE troubleshooting step at a time.
When a Terminal command is needed, provide the exact command and explain what it does.
Wait for my result before giving the next step.
Do not ask me to share passwords, API keys, bot tokens, or private credentials.
Do not recommend resetting OpenClaw, deleting workspace files, or overwriting configuration
without first explaining the consequences.
```

AFTER SETUP — USEFUL TERMINAL COMMANDS

What you want to do	Command
Check OpenClaw version	`openclaw --version`
Check gateway status	`openclaw gateway status`
Start the gateway	`openclaw gateway start`
Stop the gateway	`openclaw gateway stop`
Restart the gateway	`openclaw gateway restart`
Check workspace location	`openclaw config get agents.defaults.workspace`

Open dashboard	`openclaw dashboard`
Run diagnostics	`openclaw doctor`
Follow logs	`openclaw logs --follow`

Only use commands when needed. You don't need to run every command in this table.

FINAL INSTALLATION CHECKLIST

Before moving to the next video, confirm:

- ☐ I successfully installed OpenClaw
- ☐ I used the Classic QuickStart setup path
- ☐ I reviewed the security notice
- ☐ I selected my AI provider
- ☐ I configured the correct authentication method
- ☐ I entered my API key
- ☐ I selected my default AI model
- ☐ My model connection test passed (if offered)
- ☐ I kept the default local gateway settings
- ☐ I skipped Discord configuration (we'll do that in Video 3)
- ☐ I skipped optional memory embeddings, skills, and hooks
- ☐ I installed the background gateway service
- ☐ I checked the gateway status
- ☐ I set up Tavily web search
- ☐ I know where my workspace folder is located
- ☐ I have kept all credentials private

UP NEXT — MODULE 4, VIDEO 2

OpenClaw is now installed. Your AI model is configured. Your workspace is ready.

But your AI CEO still needs the personalized identity, personality, business knowledge, and operating instructions you created earlier in the course.

In the next video, we'll place those files into your OpenClaw workspace.

That's when your installation begins becoming your own AI CEO.

⭐ ONE FINAL STEP BEFORE VIDEO 2 — ENABLE WEB SEARCH!

If you haven't done it yet, go back to Step 14 in this guide and follow the Tavily setup instructions. This gives your AI CEO the ability to research current information online — competitors, market trends, industry news, business opportunities.

Once Tavily is connected, you're ready for **Module 4, Video 2 — Install Your AI CEO's Brain!**